

SANTA CLARA UNIVERSITY

Leavey School of Business

Natural Language Processing

ISBA 2411 | Team Project Rubric

Santa Clara University | Leavey School of Business

Team Project Rubric

Evaluation of the Final Team Project (max 4 students). Worth 300 points — 30% of the 1000-point course total — distributed across the five dimensions by weight (Points column); each dimension is scored 1–5, and earned points scale with that score.

Dimension	Weight	Points	5 — Exceptional	4 — Strong	3 — Adequate	2 — Developing	1 — Weak
Ideation	15%	45	45 pts — Novel, high-impact problem; compelling NLP rationale; nuanced stakeholder understanding.	36 pts — Well-scoped, original problem; strong NLP fit; risks and constraints noted.	27 pts — Clear problem with reasonable NLP alignment; target user and context described.	18 pts — Problem identified but loosely defined; NLP fit plausible but not argued.	9 pts — Vague or poorly scoped problem; NLP relevance unclear; no target user defined.
Execution	40%	120	120 pts — Production-quality system; rigorous evaluation and ablations; artifact is deployable.	96 pts — Polished implementation; justified design; multi-metric evaluation with error analysis.	72 pts — Working end-to-end pipeline; reasonable model choices; at least one metric; reproducible.	48 pts — Code runs with significant errors; basic pipeline present but evaluation flawed.	24 pts — Code does not run or is incorrect; no evaluation; design incomplete.
Presentation	20%	60	60 pts — Standout delivery; introduces new tools or insights; inspires further inquiry.	48 pts — Compelling narrative; results contextualized against baselines; polished slides and demo.	36 pts — Clear problem-to-solution arc; results communicated; Q&A competent; demo functional.	24 pts — Basic structure but key points underdeveloped; demo not shown or broken.	12 pts — Unclear narrative; audience cannot follow; slides sparse or disorganized.
Business Impact	15%	45	45 pts — Convincing business case with ROI, stakeholder mapping, and deployment roadmap.	36 pts — Concrete impact framing with quantified outcomes; scalability addressed.	27 pts — Clear use case; plausible value proposition; deployment constraints considered.	18 pts — Business context mentioned but not integrated; ROI framing vague.	9 pts — No real-world connection; value proposition absent; purely academic.
Responsible AI	10%	30	30 pts — Governance appendix; red-teaming conducted; Shapley or fairness audits included.	24 pts — Structured risk assessment; fairness metrics discussed; privacy integrated.	18 pts — Key risks identified; at least one mitigation proposed; governance noted.	12 pts — Risks acknowledged superficially; no mitigation proposed.	6 pts — No consideration of bias, fairness, privacy, or governance.

Each level cell shows the points earned at that score ($\text{dimension max} \times \text{level} \div 5$). Dimension maxima: Ideation 45, Execution 120, Presentation 60, Business Impact 45, Responsible AI 30 — total 300 (30% of the 1000-point course).

This rubric is a companion to the ISBA 2411 course syllabus; see the syllabus for overall grade weighting and the Final Team Project milestone schedule.